

GENORA'26 — Technical Symposium

PROMPT PARADOX

Participant Rule Book

1. ABOUT THE EVENT

Prompt Paradox is a competitive technical event designed to test participants' ability to solve problems, reason logically, use AI effectively, verify information, analyze technical situations, and make decisions under time pressure.

The event rewards **thinking with AI rather than blindly depending on AI**.

Participants may encounter challenges involving fundamental areas of Computer Science, programming, logical reasoning, technical interpretation, AI-assisted problem-solving, and evidence-based decision-making.

Advanced specialization in a particular field is not required. Participants are expected to use the information provided, their existing knowledge, logical reasoning, and the tools permitted for each round.

2. PARTICIPATION FORMAT

Participants may compete as:

Individual

or

Team of exactly 2 members

A participant cannot compete both as an individual and as a member of another team in the same event.

The participation format selected during registration must be followed throughout the event unless the organizers explicitly permit a change.

For team participation, both members compete as a **single competitive entry**. Where a round uses a shared team session, both members share the official round state, submission, and score.

3. EVENT STRUCTURE

Prompt Paradox consists of:

Round 1 — Prompt Lock

25 minutes

Round 2 — Technical War Room

35 minutes

Conducted for participants/teams qualifying from Round 1.

Special/Surprise Round

Maximum 10–12 minutes

May be conducted if required to determine the final rankings.

The organizers will provide the instructions and conditions applicable to each round before that round begins.

4. ROUND 1 — PROMPT LOCK

Duration

25 minutes

Objective

Round 1 is a nonlinear technical challenge.

Participants/teams will encounter a sequence of technical challenges in which solving one challenge may determine the next challenge to be attempted.

The path through the challenge is intentionally not presented as a simple sequential quiz.

Challenges may involve:

- Fundamental Computer Science concepts
- Programming
- Data structures and algorithms
- Databases
- Computer networks
- Operating systems
- Logical reasoning
- Technical interpretation
- AI-assisted problem-solving

The purpose of the round is to evaluate how effectively participants can understand, solve, and navigate technical challenges under a strict time limit.

AI

AI may be available as a permitted tool during this round.

Where AI is permitted, participants remain responsible for evaluating and verifying the information produced by AI.

An AI-generated response is not automatically considered correct.

Qualification for Round 2

Participants/teams will be ranked according to their Round 1 performance.

The top 25% of eligible participating participants/teams will qualify for Round 2, subject to a minimum of 9 and a normal maximum of 15 qualifiers.

If fewer than 9 eligible participants/teams participate, the organizers may allow all eligible participants/teams to proceed.

If multiple participants/teams have the same score at the qualification boundary, all participants/teams sharing that qualifying score will advance, even if this causes the normal maximum of 15 to be exceeded.

The qualification rule will be applied consistently to all participants/teams.

5. ROUND 2 — TECHNICAL WAR ROOM

Duration

35 minutes

Round 2 is a technical investigation challenge.

Qualified participants/teams will be distributed across **three equivalent case scenarios**.

Each case presents a technical situation that must be investigated and resolved.

Participants/teams will be expected to:

1. Understand the technical situation.
2. Examine the available evidence.
3. Identify possible explanations.
4. Investigate using permitted resources.
5. Use AI intelligently where permitted.
6. Verify AI-generated suggestions.
7. Make a technical decision.
8. Provide a justified final conclusion.

The three cases may involve different scenarios and technical domains, but they follow a common evaluation structure so that performances can be compared fairly.

Important

Participants are **not automatically competing only against the participants assigned to their case**.

Performances from all three case groups will be evaluated on a common scale, and the Round 2 ranking will be based on overall performance.

6. SPECIAL / SURPRISE ROUND

A Special/Surprise Round **may be conducted if required** to determine the final rankings.

Maximum Duration

10–12 minutes

The Special Round is intentionally not described in detail in this Rule Book.

If the round is activated, the organizers will provide the necessary instructions, task details, permitted resources, and conditions immediately before the round begins.

Participants should therefore be prepared to respond to a short, high-pressure technical challenge and follow the instructions provided at the venue.

The Special Round may affect the final ranking.

7. FINAL SCORING

Performance is evaluated across the applicable rounds.

Because the rounds have different structures, their scores are converted to an **equivalent scale** before being combined for final ranking.

The final result may consider:

- Round 1
- Round 2
- Special Round, **if conducted**

Each applicable round contributes according to the scoring method established for that round.

The official scores recorded by the organizers will determine the final ranking.

The final ranking will determine:

 **1st Place**  **2nd Place**  **3rd Place**

8. AI USAGE

AI is an intentional component of Prompt Paradox.

Where AI is permitted, participants may use it as a tool for:

- Understanding technical information
- Exploring possible solutions
- Generating hypotheses
- Checking reasoning
- Interpreting evidence
- Exploring alternative approaches

Participants remain responsible for their final answers, decisions, and submissions.

Participants should not assume that an AI response is correct merely because it is confident, detailed, or technically worded.

The event may deliberately include situations in which AI-generated information must be questioned, verified, or rejected.

Where a round restricts or disables AI access, participants must follow the instructions applicable to that round.

9. GENERAL CONDUCT

Participants must:

1. Follow all instructions given by the event coordinators.
2. Remain within the permitted event environment.
3. Use only the resources explicitly permitted for each round.
4. Submit responses before the relevant deadline.
5. Immediately report genuine technical problems to the coordinators.
6. Respect other participants and event staff.
7. Avoid any activity that provides an unauthorized competitive advantage.

10. PROHIBITED ACTIVITIES

The following may result in disqualification:

- Sharing answers or solutions with another participant/team.
- Receiving unauthorized assistance.

- Accessing another participant's/team's account, challenge, submission, or information.
- Attempting to manipulate or exploit the event platform.
- Attempting to bypass restrictions imposed during a round.
- Deliberately interfering with another participant/team.
- Misrepresenting participant or team identity.
- Using unauthorized tools or resources.
- Any other action determined by the organizers to provide an unfair competitive advantage.

11. TIME LIMITS

Time limits are an essential part of Prompt Paradox.

Participants must submit their responses within the time provided for the respective round.

Once the applicable timer expires:

- Further work may not be accepted.
- Late submissions may not receive consideration.
- The organizers may lock submissions automatically where applicable.

Participants are responsible for monitoring the available time and ensuring that required responses are submitted before the deadline.

12. TECHNICAL ISSUES

If a participant encounters a genuine technical issue:

1. Inform the nearest event coordinator immediately.
2. Do not attempt to interfere with the event system.
3. Do not modify system files or configurations unless specifically instructed by an organizer.
4. Follow the instructions provided by the coordinators.

The organizers will determine an appropriate response based on the nature and impact of the technical issue.

13. EVENT-DAY INSTRUCTIONS

Participants must follow the instructions provided immediately before each round.

Certain information may intentionally be withheld until the relevant round begins in order to preserve the competitive nature of the event.

Participants should therefore pay close attention to all instructions given by the coordinators.

14. QUALIFICATION AND RANKING

Qualification and ranking will be based on the official scores recorded by the event organizers.

Where a tie occurs at a qualification or final-ranking boundary, the organizers will apply the predetermined tie-handling procedure applicable to that stage.

Participants should not assume that equal raw scores will automatically result in shared positions.

15. ORGANIZER AUTHORITY

The event organizers reserve the right to:

- Clarify or interpret event rules.
- Resolve procedural or technical issues.
- Take appropriate action in cases of suspected unfair practice.
- Modify operational arrangements when necessary to maintain fairness and continuity.
- Make decisions regarding technical incidents that affect the conduct of the event.

Any such decision will be made with the objective of maintaining a fair competition for all participants.

16. PARTICIPANT ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

By registering for Prompt Paradox, the participant confirms that they have:

- Read the Participant Rule Book.
- Understood the participation requirements.
- Understood the event structure.
- Understood the time constraints.
- Understood the AI usage conditions.
- Agreed to follow the event rules and instructions.

- Agreed to the organizers' procedures for qualification, evaluation, and ranking.

Participants are strongly advised to read this Rule Book completely before registering for Prompt Paradox.

THINK. PROMPT. VERIFY. DECIDE.

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